

LEVEL 1 — THE AXTON RESIDENCE

Event Timeline

Rules to find: 3 (shown to the player)

1. DO NOT + TURN ON + LIGHT
2. DO NOT + TAKE + TEDDY BEAR
3. DO NOT + TAKE + PURPLE BALLOON

Scripted runtime: 5:15. With deliberation and the report window, a level plays in 6–7 minutes.

Agent Assignments

Agent	Room	Delivers	Later actions
RES	Children's Bedroom	Clue 1 — storybook	Action 2 (balloons), Action 6 (lamp)
DAVE	Master Bedroom	Clue 2 — journal	Action 3 (teddy bear), Action 4 (stitch)
ELLIE	Dining Room	Clue 3 — light bulbs	Action 1 (lights)
WALKER	Living Room → <i>player's choice</i>	<i>(no clues)</i>	Action 7 (relocate), Action 5 (the voice)

Analyst: HALE

Room occupancy

Window	Living	Children's	Master	Dining
0:00 – 1:45	WALKER	RES	DAVE	ELLIE
1:45 – end	<i>(empty)</i>	RES	DAVE	ELLIE

Window	Living	Children's	Master	Dining
		+WALKER if sent here	+WALKER if sent here	+WALKER if sent here

Never more than two in a room, whichever destination the player picks. The Living Room empties at 1:45 and stays empty for nearly three minutes before the voice calls from it.

Timeline

Phase 1 — Information only (0:15 – 1:00)

Four beats, 15 seconds apart. No lethal events. All of this is permanent, so tight spacing costs nothing — the player can leave popups stacked and read them during the gaps in Phase 2.

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
0:00	—	—	Team enters and disperses. Unlocks room nouns: LIVING ROOM CHILDREN'S BEDROOM MASTER BEDROOM DINING ROOM	
0:15	Analyst Picture	HALE	Analyst A — crime scene photo, a man dead on the floor clutching a teddy bear (photo). Region-click the bear → unlocks TEDDY BEAR	You might want to see this.
0:30	Clue	RES	Clue 1 — open storybook,	I'm seeing a book, seems to

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
			Children's Bedroom. A vampire recoiling from lamplight, with the same face as the girl in Analyst A (photo). Unlocks when lamp clicked LIGHT	be a children's book actually. It's turned to a specific page. There's a vampire recoiling from lamplight. I might be going crazy, but the vampire's face kind of looks like Clara...
0:45	Clue	DAVE	Clue 2 — journal, Master Bedroom. <i>"Clara keeps complaining about her teddy bear falling apart. I finally got her a new button to put on it but she refused and screamed that she hated purple. Kids..."</i> (text) No unlock	Found a journal in a drawer. I took the liberty of opening it, and this page looks like it might help ya. It reads: <i>"Clara keeps complaining about her teddy bear falling apart. I finally got her a new button to put on it but she refused and screamed that she hated purple. Kids..."</i>
1:00	Clue	ELLIE	Clue 3 — every bulb in the Dining Room has been unscrewed and lined up in a neat row on the table (photo). No	Oh dear, it's so dark in the dining room. It looks like somebody unscrewed all the lightbulbs and lined them up in a neat row near the table.

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
			unlock; reinforces Rule 1	Luckily I'm not scared of the dark!

Analyst A must precede Clue 1 for the "that's the same girl" recognition to land.

Phase 2 — First input, then first threat (1:20 – 3:05)

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
1:20	Action 7	WALKER	<i>(the relocation)</i> <i>"Living room's picked clean. Where do you want me?" —</i> 25s → resolves 1:45. Non-lethal directive. Player sends ENTER + <ROOM> . Valid: Children's Bedroom, Master Bedroom, Dining Room. No input → random of the three. Living Room is not a valid destination	Sir, the living room has been thoroughly searched and I haven't found any clues. Where is my assignment now?
2:00	Action 1	ELLIE	<i>"It's really dark in here. Should I turn the lights on?" —</i> 20s → resolves 2:20. LETHAL on yes. Safe: DO NOT + TURN ON + LIGHT . Informed by Clue 1 (0:30)	I LIED I AM TOTALLY FREAKED OUT BY THE DARK. I think I'm going to turn the lights on.

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
			and Clue 3 (1:00)	
2:45	Action 3	DAVE	<i>"There's a teddy bear here. Should I take it as evidence?"</i> — 20s → resolves 3:05. LETHAL on take. Safe: DO NOT + TAKE + TEDDY BEAR. Informed by Analyst A (0:15). Refusing unlocks Action 4	There's a lil brownTeddy Bear here. Looks like somethin' my son used to play with, though it's clearly worn. You want me to take it as evidence?
2:50	Analyst Picture	HALE	Analyst B — family portrait, the girl holding the bear. The bear one eye is missing a button (photo). click the bear's face unlocks STITCH . <i>Lands five seconds into a lethal countdown — the first time the player must ignore new information to save someone</i>	There's something off about this picture. Figure out what it is.

On Action 7: the player's first input of the level, and it costs nothing to get wrong. It teaches directive commands and the **ENTER** + room-noun pattern before any stakes exist. Destination has no mechanical consequence — Action 5 fires wherever Walker ends up, because the voice calls from the empty Living Room regardless.

Optional, if you have time: if the player sends Walker to the Dining Room, **ELLIE** adds one line at Action 5 — *"I don't hear anything."* A quiet reward for a choice that otherwise doesn't matter.

Phase 3 — Double pressure (3:20 – 3:55)

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
3:20	Action 2	RES	<i>"I found a red and purple balloon. Should I take one?"</i> — 25s → resolves 3:45. Unlocks RED BALLOON and PURPLE BALLOON on arrival. TAKE + RED BALLOON = +100. TAKE + PURPLE BALLOON = LETHAL. No command = random of the three. Informed by Clue 2 (0:45)	Hey, I dont even know why I'm asking YOU this, but I see a red and purple balloon. Should I take one? Actually, yeah, I am gonna take one, maybe that'll bring some joy to this miserable existence. I'll let you pick the color though.
3:35	Action 4	DAVE	<i>"Wait, I think I see a red button and some string. Should I stitch it onto the bear? It looks so sad."</i> — 20s → resolves 3:55. STITCH + TEDDY BEAR = +100. Otherwise nothing. Non-lethal. Requires Action 3 answered correctly.	I see a red button and some strong, plus the bear's missin' an eye. Should I stitch it on? I feel bad for the poor thing.

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
			Informed by Analyst B (2:50)	
3:45	Analyst Description	HALE	Analyst C — background file on Clara. She wanted to be a voice actor when she grew up. Her mother's statement describes her practising different voices constantly, all through the house, at all hours. Unlocks VOICE	Got some info on Clara before her demise.

Overlap: 3:35 – 3:45. Two agents demanding input, but only one can die. The correct read is to answer RES and let DAVE wait — a player who chases the bonus loses an agent.

Analyst C lands during the *benign* countdown, which is deliberate. It's the one piece of information the player can afford to open while a clock is running, and it needs to actually be read.

Phase 4 — Peak (4:30 – 5:00)

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
4:30	Action 6	RES	<i>"There's a lamp on the nightstand. If I switch it on I could photograph the whole room properly."</i> — 20s → resolves 4:50.	So there's a lamp on the nightstand. If I turn it on it'll let me see the whole room properly. Don't see why I shouldn't do it,

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
			LETHAL on yes. Safe: DO NOT + TURN ON + LIGHT . Pure retention test — no new information required	but I felt like you were the type to tell me stupid things, so thought I might as well ask you.
4:40	Action 5	WALKER	<i>"I can hear RES calling me from the living room. Should I go?"</i> — 20s → resolves 5:00. LETHAL on go. Safe: DO NOT + ANSWER + VOICE . The tell is the status panel: RES is in the Children's Bedroom. Informed by Analyst C (3:45)	Sir, I can hear Res calling me from the living room. Should I proceed?

Overlap: 4:40 – 5:00. Both lethal. The misdirection is the point — the player is mid-command *with RES* when a voice claiming to be RES calls from a room that has been empty since 1:45. The status line they need is the one already under their cursor.

Phase 5 — Report window (5:15 →)

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
5:15	Message	HALE	<i>"Command wants the report. How many rules do you have?"</i> — a prompt, not a hint	You're out of time. HQ wants the report, have you figured out anything?

T	Type	Actor	Beat	Full Text
—	—	—	Player submits whenever ready → extraction sequence	

Why this ordering

No agent can die before delivering a clue. All three room clues land by 1:00; the first lethal action is at 2:00. Walker has no clues at all and his only pre-finale action is non-lethal. There is no path through this level where a death costs the player information.

The only survival-gated content is a bonus. Action 4 requires DAVE to have survived Action 3, and it's worth points, not knowledge.

Early submission is blocked structurally. PURPLE BALLOON doesn't exist as a keyword until Action 2 fires at 3:20, so Rule 3 is unwritable before then. Since the rule count is public, a player who knew the level could otherwise submit at 1:05 with everyone alive and skip most of the content.

Lead times.

Action	Informed by	Lead
Action 7 (relocate)	room nouns @ 0:00	1:20
Action 1 (lights)	Clue 1 @ 0:30	1:30
Action 3 (teddy)	Analyst A @ 0:15	2:30
Action 2 (balloon)	Clue 2 @ 0:45	2:35
Action 4 (stitch)	Analyst B @ 2:50	0:45 (<i>non-lethal</i>)
Action 6 (lamp)	Clue 1 @ 0:30	4:00
Action 5 (voice)	Analyst C @ 3:45	0:55

Density curve — demands per 30-second window:

- Phase 1  information only, 15s apart
- Phase 2  one input, then one action at a time
- Phase 3  two actions overlapping + a clue
- Phase 4  two lethal countdowns running together
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Fallback rules for dead agents

Situation	Behaviour
RES dead before 4:30	Skip Action 6. If DAVE is alive, reassign to him with the Master Bedroom lamp
DAVE dead before 3:35	Action 4 never fires (already the case if Action 3 was failed)
ELLIE dead	No downstream effect
WALKER dead before 4:40	Not possible — Action 5 is his only lethal beat
Action 5 voice naming	Names any living agent whose status shows a room other than the Living Room. If none are alive, it names a dead agent — the loudest possible tell